Missoula Community Life

Website Proposal for the Missoula City Council

Project Overview

I want to create a welcoming community website that helps Missoula residents find local experiences based on their interests, needs, and circumstances. Missoula has concerts, plays, art shows, recreational activities, sporting events, local businesses, and many other opportunities, but information about them is often spread across different websites and social media pages. This can make it difficult for residents to know what is happening or where to start looking.

The long-term goal is to make this website a central place for discovering all things Missoula. Residents would be able to explore activities happening this week, this month, or later in the year. The website would feature experiences from across the city and represent different ages, interests, schedules, budgets, and abilities.

Since the first version must be completed by one designer in three weeks, I would begin with a focused collection of events and activities. This would establish a useful structure that could grow into a more complete community resource over time.

Audience and Purpose

The website would be designed for Missoula residents looking for things to do in their community. The audience could include families searching for weekend activities, students looking for concerts or social events, older adults interested in theater and art, people who just moved here, and anyone hoping to discover local businesses or outdoor recreation.

The site would also account for practical needs. Some residents may need free activities, wheelchair-accessible locations, family-friendly events, or options that do not require advance registration. Each listing should provide enough information for visitors to decide whether an activity is right for them.

The main purpose would be to make local opportunities easier to discover. Rather than requiring people to search several websites, the site would place selected Missoula events and activities in one organized location.

Website Content

The website would feature many types of local experiences, including concerts, plays, art shows, sporting events, ice skating, gaming, parks, community programs, and local business events. Visitors could browse by category or by time.

A “This Week in Missoula” section would highlight upcoming activities that residents could attend soon. Monthly listings would help people plan ahead, while a yearly calendar would feature annual festivals, seasonal activities, and other major community events.

Each listing would include the event name, date and time, location, cost, category, and a short description. When that information is available, it could also include the recommended age range, accessibility details, registration requirements, and a link to the organizer’s official page.

Design and Accessibility

The website would have a welcoming style that reflects Missoula’s community. The homepage would immediately show visitors what is happening soon, while clear navigation would help them explore additional categories.

Activities would be displayed through reusable cards so every listing presents information in a familiar order. Visitors would not need to relearn the layout as they browse. The site would also use readable text, clear headings, descriptive links, strong color contrast, and alternative text for images.

The responsive design would work across phones, tablets, and desktop computers. Mobile access would be especially important because residents may search for nearby activities while they are already out in the community.

Project Scope

The long-term vision is to feature activities from all around Missoula in one place. Maintaining a complete and current citywide event database would require more time, research, and ongoing support than one designer could provide during a three-week project.

For the first version, I would create the foundation for that larger resource. It would include a responsive homepage, clear activity categories, weekly and monthly discovery sections, a small annual-events section, and a carefully selected collection of real listings. The site could link to official sources so residents can confirm details and register when necessary.

Features such as user accounts, personalized recommendations, ticket sales, public event submissions, and a large searchable database would be saved for a later phase. Limiting the first version would allow me to create a reliable and polished starting point instead of overpromising a system that could not be completed or maintained within the timeline.

Three-Week Plan

During the first week, I would confirm the client’s priorities, organize the event categories, collect the initial content, and create sketches of the homepage and listing system. I would also identify which details each event card needs to include.

During the second week, I would create the visual design and build the responsive layout. I would ask the art director, other designers, and potential users to review the navigation and test whether activities are easy to find. The client would then provide the first round of feedback on the design direction.

During the third week, I would refine the approved design, enter the final event content, and test the site on multiple devices. The second round of client feedback would focus on usability, accuracy, and final corrections. Once the design direction is approved, the project would allow up to three client-requested revisions.

Measuring Success

The site would be successful if residents could quickly understand its purpose and find an activity that fits their interests and circumstances. Testing could ask users to find a free weekend activity, a family-friendly event, an art show, or something happening later in the year.

The first version would also be successful if it created a clear system that the city could continue updating. A reusable structure would make it easier to add more events and categories later without rebuilding the website.

The Final Vision

My long-term vision is to create one trusted place for all things Missoula. Whether someone wants to attend a concert, see a play, visit an art show, watch a sporting event, explore a park, or support a local business, the website would help them discover what the community has to offer.

The first three-week project would not contain every event in Missoula, but it would create a focused and accessible foundation. It would give residents immediate value while setting the project on a realistic path toward becoming a complete community resource.